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UNIT 1

Present Tense Revision

Grammar guide redesigned for a clearer, more visual and student-friendly revision.

What will you revise?	Why this guide is useful
Present Simple: form, uses, adverbs of frequency and time expressions.	Short rules and examples to help you remember grammar more easily.
State Verbs: verbs we do not usually use in continuous forms.	Tables and colour blocks to compare tenses at a glance.
Present Continuous: form, uses and common time expressions.	Examples linked to everyday life and IT contexts to make learning more meaningful.
Present Perfect Simple: form, uses and key contrasts with Past Simple.	

Grammar tip: focus on meaning first. Ask yourself: Is it a habit? Is it happening now? Is the result important now?

Tense	Main idea	Example
Present Simple	habits, routines, permanent facts	The server **starts** automatically every morning.
Present Continuous	actions happening now / temporary actions	The technician **is checking** the cables now.
Present Perfect Simple	past action with a present result / life experience	We **have installed** the new software.

1. Present Simple

Form
Affirmative: I/You/We/They work - He/She/It works
Negative: do not / does not + infinitive
Question: Do / Does + subject + infinitive?

Spelling rules
Add **-s** to most verbs: *work -> works*
Add **-es** after *ch, o, s, sh, x, z*: *watch -> watches*
Change consonant + **y** into **-ies**: *study -> studies*
Use **do/does** for emphasis: *I do like travelling by train.*

We use Present Simple to ...
talk about habits and routines: Toby walks to work.
say how often things happen: Angela doesn't visit us very often.
describe permanent situations: Carlo works in a travel agency.
describe states: Do you have an up-to-date passport?
express general truths and facts: Poland is in the European Union.

Common time expressions
every day / week / year, once a week, twice a month, in the morning, at night, on Monday, in July, today, always, usually, often, sometimes, never

Use Present Simple when the situation is regular, permanent or generally true.

2. Adverbs of Frequency

Frequency	Adverb	Example
100%	Always	I always study after class.
90%	Usually	I usually walk to work.
80%	Normally / Generally	I normally get good marks.
70%	Often / Frequently	I often read in bed at night.
50%	Sometimes	I sometimes sing in the shower.
30%	Occasionally	I occasionally go to bed late.
10%	Seldom	I seldom put salt on my food.
5%	Hardly ever / Rarely	I hardly ever get angry.
0%	Never	Vegetarians never eat meat.

Position in the sentence

Before a main verb: I **always remember** to do my homework.

After the verb to be: They **are never** pleased to see me.

Between an auxiliary and the main verb: I have **always done** my homework.

At the beginning of a sentence

Possible: usually, normally, often, frequently, sometimes, occasionally

Occasionally, I like to eat Thai food.

Not possible: always, seldom, rarely, hardly ever, never

3. State Verbs

What are state verbs?

State verbs do not usually have continuous tenses because they describe a **state**, not an action.

They are common with feelings, opinions, possession and the senses.

Category	Examples	Model sentence
Likes and dislikes	like, love, hate, enjoy, prefer, dislike, fancy, can't stand	Cathy likes romantic films.
Mental states / opinions	believe, know, understand, remember, forget, realise, agree, doubt, guess, hope, suppose	I don't believe a word he's saying.
Possession / other states	be, have (= possess), belong, own, need, want, include, weigh, cost, matter, contain, fit, deserve	This book is mine. It belongs to me.
Perception / senses	see, hear, smell, taste, feel, look, sound, seem, touch	The soup tastes delicious. Dad is in the attic. I can hear him.

Common mistake: avoid forms like I am knowing or She is wanting. Use I know and She wants.

4. Present Continuous

Form	Spelling rules
Affirmative: subject + am / is / are + verb-ing	Add **-ing**: read -> reading
Negative: subject + am / is / are + not + verb-ing	Drop final **-e**: write -> writing, ride -> riding
Question: Am / Is / Are + subject + verb-ing?	Double the final consonant in **CVC** verbs: stop -> stopping, run -> running

We use Present Continuous to ...

describe actions happening now: Mike is driving to work at the moment.

describe temporary series of actions: Taxi drivers aren't stopping at the station because of the roadworks.

describe temporary situations: I am working in New York this week.

describe changing or developing situations: Holidays abroad are becoming increasingly popular.

Common time expressions

now, right now, at the moment, currently, nowadays, at present, these days, this morning / week / month / year, today

5. Present Simple vs Present Continuous

Present Simple	Present Continuous
General truths It rarely rains in the desert.	**Actions happening now** She is reading a book upstairs.
Present habits John goes to the dance club every Thursday.	**Annoying habits (+ always)** She is always singing in the shower.
Permanent states He works at a hotel.	**Temporary states** She is working at the hotel until next week.
Timetable events The plane to London takes off at 6.30 am.	**Future arrangements** She is getting married on 3 November.

Quick check: use Present Simple for routine or permanence; use Present Continuous for actions in progress or temporary situations.

6. Present Perfect Simple

Affirmative	Negative	Question
I / You / We / They **have worked** He / She / It **has worked**	I / You / We / They **haven't worked** He / She / It **hasn't worked**	**Have** I / you / we / they worked? **Has** he / she / it worked?

We use Present Perfect Simple to ...

talk about situations and states that started in the past and are still true: She's had her motorbike for over six years.

describe a series of actions continuing up to now: We've travelled by taxi, bus, plane and train - all in the last twenty-four hours!

talk about completed actions when the time is not mentioned: Have you ever flown in a helicopter?

focus on the present result of a completed action: I've booked the coach tickets.

use expressions such as It's the first / second / third time ... *It's the second time I've been on a plane.*

Common time expressions

ever, never, already, just, yet

for, since

recently, lately

so far, up to now, until now

Present Perfect vs Past Simple

Present Perfect: time is not finished / not mentioned, or the result matters now. *I have lost my keys.*

Past Simple: the time is finished and usually mentioned. *I lost my keys yesterday.*

Question contrast: *Have you ever visited London? / When did you visit London?*

Remember: for tells us a duration (for two years), while since tells us the starting point (since 2024).

Well done! Use this guide to revise Unit 1 before doing your exercises.